

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 204

By Hensley

A RESOLUTION recognizing the Christian Heritage Flag as the official flag representing Christian Heritage Month in Tennessee.

WHEREAS, in 2024, the General Assembly passed legislation (codified at Tennessee Code Annotated, Section 4-1-424) designating the month of November as Christian Heritage Month; and

WHEREAS, faith and community leaders from around Tennessee created the Christian Heritage Flag and its symbolic meaning to further commemorate the month and to serve as a symbol recognizing the bountiful influence Christianity has had on the State of Tennessee and the United States; and

WHEREAS, the Christian Heritage Flag was a staple decor during Tennessee's first annual Christian Heritage Fest; was recognized on local radio and television in Nashville leading up to November; was distributed to event attendees; and was flown proudly by Tennesseans during the month of November; and

WHEREAS, the left vertical white stripe represents the Old Testament of the Bible, and the twelve gold stars vertically aligned within are for the twelve tribes of Israel through whom God kept His promise to Abraham that through him He would establish many nations and an everlasting covenant; and

WHEREAS, the seven blue and white alternating horizontal stripes represent the six days of creation and the seventh day when God rested from His work; and

WHEREAS, the circular center medallion represents the New Testament of the Bible and eternal life in Christ, and the twelve white stars aligned in the inside perimeter are for the

twelve disciples of the Lord Jesus Christ through whom Christ initiated the spreading of the gospel across the world; and

WHEREAS, the color gold represents God's glory, holiness, and the testing of our faith; blue symbolizes God's power, authority, and presence; and white represents righteousness, purity, and dedication to God; and

WHEREAS, the cross in the center of the medallion represents the ultimate sacrifice that the Lord Jesus Christ made wherein all mankind can be saved; and

WHEREAS, when flying this flag, individuals should remember to submit their lives to the Lord Jesus Christ for His work and service, the work and sacrifice that God wrought to bring joy and life everlasting to all of mankind, and the eternal reward that God has placed on all those whom He calls His children; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we recognize the Christian Heritage Flag as the official flag representing Christian Heritage Month in Tennessee.